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LabStart Hiring Team

LabStart

RE: OPERATIONS ASSOCIATE

Dear LabStart Hiring Team,

I'm applying for the Operations Associate role because I genuinely like this kind of work — the unglamorous engine underneath a small, ambitious team. I've spent fifteen years inside lean, mission-driven organizations, and the roles I've enjoyed most were the ones where I got to spot what was broken, fix it, and write down how it works so it stays fixed. **That's the job description here, and it's the job I actually want.**

On the CRM and systems side: I owned Salesforce CRM administration end to end at Zayo Group — Einstein, Marketing Cloud, data hygiene, automations, and reporting — and at Lytics I administered an enterprise customer data platform for a major account, keeping the data clean and the reporting trustworthy. I also helped build the customer-delivery playbook at Lytics, which is exactly the kind of SOP work this role is asking for: document the process well enough that it survives someone else running it.

On automation specifically, I'm not coming to this cold. I'm currently a founding technical advisor at a small startup where I build AI-agent workflows — Claude Code sub-agents, RAG pipelines, prompt libraries — whose whole purpose is taking manual, repetitive work off a small team's plate. I'd bring that same instinct to LabStart's tool stack from day one.

I'm also genuinely comfortable in the "everyone wears many hats" environment LabStart describes. I've worked inside seed-stage startups and small businesses — managing inventory and vendor relationships and running community events at a small retail shop, hiring and onboarding a team at an early-stage startup, keeping a lean marketing team's tech stack running. Unstructured and shifting priorities is a normal week for me, not an exception.

On location: I'd have no problem moving to Salida — I already have close friends there, so it wouldn't be starting from zero. I'd be glad to be in the office on the schedule this role needs.

I care about climate action beyond this application — it's the thread running through most of what I've chosen to work on lately — and I'd welcome the chance to talk about how I could help LabStart's small team run better.

Thank you for considering my application.

Warmly,

Katrina Engelsted

BOULDER, COLORADO